

World in Brief: Burnham becomes Britain's PM; Hamas picks a new leader



Photograph: Reuters

Andy Burnham became [Britain's prime minister](#), taking over from Sir Keir Starmer, who resigned in a meeting with King Charles. Mr Burnham has made clear his disapproval of deregulation, privatisation and deindustrialisation, but has said little about how he will tackle Britain's low economic productivity and stagnating living standards. His choice for chancellor when he forms a government later in the day will be closely watched.

Khalil al-Hayya was chosen as the new leader of Hamas, the first since Yahya Sinwar was killed by Israel in October 2024. The former head of the [Islamist militia's Gazan wing](#) rose to prominence within its five-member leadership council and served as its chief negotiator in talks for a Gaza ceasefire. He beat the organisation's political leader, Khaled Meshaal, in an internal ballot.

The EU fined **AliExpress** a record €550m (\$628m) for selling illegal and harmful goods. It said that the Chinese e-commerce platform listed products including “[counterfeit](#) clothing, unsafe toys, dangerous cosmetics”, breaching the bloc's Digital Services Act. AliExpress disagreed with the decision and called the penalty “disproportionate”. In May the EU imposed a €200m fine on Temu, another Chinese retailer.

Yemen's Houthis announced a maritime blockade on Saudi Arabia, threatening a fragile four-year truce. The [Iran-backed militia](#) said it was responding to a Saudi siege of Sana, Yemen's capital. The group said it would stem the flow of oil from the Red Sea through the [Bab al-Mandab strait](#)—a choke point through which Saudi Arabia has shipped more oil supplies since the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Ryanair, Europe's largest budget airline, reported lacklustre results for the second quarter of 2026. Post-tax profit was €538m (\$615m), down by a third from the same period last year and below analysts' expectations. That is partly because the Iran war has increased fuel prices; Ryanair's operating costs were up by 11% year on year. EasyJet, a rival, reports on Wednesday.

Supporters of **India's Cockroach Janata Party** gathered in Delhi to begin a march on parliament, defying police orders. The CJP began as a satirical social-media account following the leak of exam papers, but has since grown into a protest movement calling for education reform. On Saturday police forcibly moved Sonam Wangchuk, a hunger-striking activist, to a local hospital. But that has only galvanised protesters.

Donald Trump said that his Air Force One—a luxurious present from Qatar—will be fitted with better security. The American president chose to fly back from a NATO summit in Turkey on an older plane amid concerns the presidential plane lacked capabilities such as missile defences. Mr Trump said the swish Boeing 747-8 jumbo jet would get “maxed out” within “about a month”.

Figure of the day: 26%. The share of seats in Parliament that are in the north of England. The region has been rising in political salience—with a [new British prime minister](#) to show for it.

US in Brief: The race to replace Platner narrows in Maine



Photograph: Reuters

Two candidates dropped out of the [race to replace Graham Platner](#) as the Democratic candidate in **Maine's** Senate race. Shenna Bellows, Maine's secretary of state, and Nirav Shah, a former state health official, were among around a dozen candidates who had announced their intention to stand. Their departure makes Troy Jackson, a former state senator (pictured), favourite for the nomination, which will be decided on July 25th.

Donald Trump took centre stage as **Spain** celebrated their 1-0 victory over Argentina in the **World Cup** final in New Jersey. The president awarded the trophy to the Spanish team, alongside Gianni Infantino, the boss of FIFA. Mr Trump caused controversy during [the tournament](#) after lobbying football's governing body to overturn the suspension of an American player. Still, hosting the contest in North America was a commercial success for FIFA: it expects to have taken more than \$15bn in revenue, well above its \$11bn target.

New York's mayor, Zohran Mamdani, said he was investigating whether he could order the arrest of Binyamin Netanyahu, Israel's prime minister, should he visit the city for the United Nations General Assembly in September. The International Criminal Court [issued an arrest warrant](#) for Mr Netanyahu on war-crime charges in

2024. However, America is not a member of the court. Israeli and American officials called Mr Mamdani's comments a gimmick.

The co-founder of the Sinaloa Cartel, **Ismael “El Mayo” Zambada**, is set to be sentenced to life imprisonment at a court in Brooklyn today. Federal prosecutors said the Mexican gang distributed 1.5m kg of cocaine under his watch, making him one of the most “prolific and powerful narcotraffickers in the world”. The 78-year-old pleaded guilty to charges of running a criminal operation last year.

No off-ramp in the Gulf war



Photograph: EPA

With each passing day, what began as a limited clash between America and Iran looks to be spiralling into something bigger. They have traded strikes for nine consecutive nights. America is bombing bridges and tunnels in southern Iran, particularly around Bandar Abbas, its main port city. Iran has repeatedly attacked power and water infrastructure in Kuwait. At least two [American soldiers were killed](#) by a missile strike in Jordan on Friday.

What comes next is hard to predict. The Pentagon is sending additional refuelling tankers to Israel, a sign that it is weighing further escalation. Mediators are still trying to urge both sides back to negotiations, thus far unsuccessfully. Economic considerations should eventually force them to talk. The [price of oil](#) is already up 23% this month, and an American blockade of Iran's ports will add to the regime's economic woes. The question is how long that takes—and how much damage they will do to the region first.

Instagram on trial over teen addiction



Photograph: Getty Images

On Monday Meta goes on trial in Tennessee, accused of harming young users' mental health with its Instagram platform. The state alleges the social-media giant violated the Tennessee Consumer Protection Act by designing Instagram as an “addiction machine” targeting minors. It says Mark Zuckerberg, Meta’s CEO, repeatedly declined employees’ requests to fund measures to mitigate Instagram’s harmful effects. Meta has argued that it has strong safety measures in place to protect teens. It is also likely to challenge evidence that social media damages youngsters’ mental health.

Recent legal setbacks suggest it faces an uphill battle in the courtroom. In March jurors in California found [Meta and Google guilty](#) of harming young users. The case focused on the [design of their platforms](#) rather than user-generated content. The latter benefits from more legal protection. Meta has appealed. It faces lawsuits over alleged harm to youngsters by more than 40 states, including one in federal court next month in Oakland, California.

Weapons to the fore at Farnborough



Photograph: London News Pictures

Geopolitical risks are [fuelling the aerospace and defence sector](#). So expect the balance between commercial and defence to skew in favour of military exhibitors at the biennial International Farnborough Air Show, which opens on Monday. It has “sold out twice over”, according to its organisers.

The sixth-generation GCAP fighter programme backed by Britain, Japan and Italy, which has secured funding for the next four years, will be a star of the show. Highly valued startups, such as Germany’s Helsing and America’s Anduril, will be vying to take on established defence contractors with their autonomous air and sea uncrewed vehicles. Several Ukrainian firms offering battle-proven, low-cost drone technologies and seeking Western investment will also draw attention.

As for the civilian side, there will be less interest in the traditional contest between Airbus and Boeing for commercial-aviation order announcements. With a combined order backlog of about 17,000 airliners, delivery rather than sales is the new yardstick of success.

Colombia's civil disobedience



Photograph: Getty Images

On Monday, the day Colombia each year celebrates independence from Spanish rule, left-leaning Colombians will march in defence of national sovereignty. Gustavo Petro, the outgoing president, is calling it a “second cry” for independence. Mr Petro refuses to recognise the victory of the [right-wing](#) populist Abelardo de la Espriella, who beat his rival, Iván Cepeda, in [last month's election](#) by less than one percentage point.

Mr Cepeda has called for “peaceful civil disobedience” ahead of the handover on August 7th. The left fears that the Trump-loving Mr de la Espriella will subordinate Colombia to United States’ interests, in particular by trading access to Colombia’s national resources for America’s help in fighting drug-trafficking gangs. They are worried by his threats to extradite Mr Petro to America. Their suspicions of the country’s new leader were heightened when a Colombian delegation to Washington last week was silent on the killing of a Colombian man by ICE agents in Maine two days earlier. Expect outrage in the streets of Bogotá.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: Head & Shoulders is the best-selling brand of which type of household product?